

Sandwell RAS – Homecare Engine (Gold Standard Guide)

This guide explains how the Homecare engine calculates weekly care hours and indicative budgets in a transparent, auditable, and panel-ready way.

Core Principles

- Right care, right time, right place
- Based on eligible needs
- Reflects real provider delivery models
- Supports but does not replace professional judgement

Configured Assumptions

Element	Configured Value
Hourly Rate	£21.64
Personal Care	45 mins
Medication	15 mins
Meal Prep	30 mins
Welfare Check	30 mins
Staffing	1:1 or 2:1 (time doubled)

Calculation Steps

1. Identify eligible needs
2. Map to care tasks
3. Apply standard durations
4. Apply frequency
5. Apply staffing ratio
6. Calculate daily hours
7. Convert to weekly hours
8. Apply hourly rate

Worked Example

Morning care (45 mins), Lunch (30 mins), Evening care (45 mins), Medication (30 mins)
Total daily = 150 mins (2.5 hrs)
Weekly = 17.5 hrs
Cost = £378.70

Key Rules

- No night support included
- No duplication of calls
- Hidden services excluded
- Overrides require justification

Outputs

- Indicative budget
- Planner (daily/weekly)
- Brokerage specification
- Panel summary